Official Rulebook for Threads of Continuity

Version 0.7.2

Objective

The objective of Threads of Continuity is to be the first player to weave three Tapestries of Reality. The game, though a competitive experience, will require working with your competitors to steer the game in a certain direction, for you cannot do it alone. The reality is slowly collapsing, and you must try to be the first one out of this reality by beating your opponents. Every action that each player makes will affect all players in the subsequent rounds. Maybe you want to sabotage your opponents, or maybe you need to form a temporary alliance to get what you want. Maybe you'll change the rules and win diplomatically. The universe is yours to shape how you wish, but no matter what you do, you must get out before it's all gone.

Resources

There are five resources in Threads of Continuity, each with a distinct strategic identity that shapes how players approach the game.

Resource Identities

Threads of Continuity (ToC)

ToC is the most versatile resource in the game. It serves as the primary currency for conversions, utility actions, and general-purpose spending. If you have ToC, you can always do something — it is the reliable backbone that keeps your options open. ToC can be converted into any other resource at fixed exchange rates (see below), making it essential for adapting to whatever the game demands.

Spatial Nodes (SN)

SN is the primary currency for building and upgrading Production Nodes. It represents long-term investment and infrastructure. Players who invest heavily in SN are building the engine that will power their late-game strategy. SN is how you scale up and become powerful over time.

Temporal Bridges (TB)

TB is the rarest and most impactful resource for weaving Tapestries of Reality. It carries the highest coefficient weight in the weaving formula. TB is difficult to acquire — it can only be obtained through resource collection dice rolls (11-12), Production Nodes, or converting 5 ToC.

Dimensional Ripples (DR)

DR is the currency of disruption and hostile action. All player interaction actions, sabotage attempts, and offensive plays cost DR. DR also creates risk — it counts against you in the weaving formula denominator, and high DR levels can trigger penalties during reconciliation. DR lets you mess with people, but at a cost.

Quantum Residues (QR)

QR represents the game pushing back against players. It is primarily a liability — it drags down your weaving chances, and accumulating 20 or more QR triggers an unstable timeline that forfeits your next turn. However, QR can also be weaponized: spending 15 QR triggers an Ethereal Chaos Event, which can be a powerful and costly strategic tool. QR is the residue of dangerous play — maybe a cost, maybe a weapon, never neutral.

Game Structure

1. Player Composition and Requirements

1.1 Requirements for Play

- 3-5 players
- 1 notebook for each player
- 1 pen for each player
- 2 d6 dice
- 1 d100 die
- Methods for tracking ToC, TB, SN, QR, DR, and ToR
- Method for logging spent resources
    - Tracking can be done with the Threads of Continuity app, or the TOC-EZ form.

1.2 Setup

1.2.1 Player Turn Order

1. All players will roll both dice and multiply the number together.
2. Players will now divide that number by their birth month.
3. Then take that number and add your birth day.
4. Turn order is determined in ascending order.
5. If the time is after 6 o'clock, play in reverse order.

1.2.2 Player Starting Resources

Every player starts with the following:

- 5 Threads of Continuity (ToC)
- 2 Dimensional Ripples (DR)
- 1 Spatial Node (SN)
- 2 Quantum Residues (QR)
- 0 Temporal Bridges (TB)

1.2.2.1 Resource Tracking

All players must track the number of each resource they have spent in a round. This number will be used to determine the Total Resource Usage at the start of the next round. This can be done by any method of the player's choosing.

Note: "Lowering" a resource counts towards the spending of that resource.

2. Game Phases

2.1 Game Phases

1. Preliminary Phase
2. Resource Collection Phase
3. Merging Phase
4. Weaving Phase
5. Reconciliation Phase
6. Ending Phase

2.1.1 Preliminary Phase

This first phase is in place to set the starting Reality Constant and the Weaving Coefficients. These values must be recalculated at the start of each round and affect all players for the duration of the round. See *Coefficient Formula* and *Reality Constant Formula* for information on how to do this. This is only to be done once before the first player's turn, not at the start of each player's turn.

Players may also opt to skip their turn entirely to reduce their QR by up to 10 (or by whatever QR they have, if less than 10). The actual amount of QR lost is recorded as usage for coefficient calculations.

2.1.2 Resource Collection Phase

This phase focuses on collecting resources needed for the rest of the turn and the rest of the game. The phase plays out as follows:

1. Collect any resources from Production Nodes (PNs) that you may have. This happens automatically at the start of this phase.
2. The player will roll the two d6 dice. If the resulting sum of the dice is:
    - 2-5: Gain 3 ToC
    - 6-8: Gain 2 DR
    - 9-10: Gain 2 SN
    - 11-12: Gain 1 TB
3. After collecting all resources, the player will log their current resources for each resource type.

2.1.3 Merging Phase

This phase focuses on using collected resources and turning them into other resources, exchanging resources, trading, alliance building, purchasing Production Nodes, and sabotage.

2.1.3.1 Purchasing Production Nodes

Production Nodes are crucial to mid- and late-game success. See *Production Nodes* for more info.

2.1.3.2 Sabotage

Cost: 3 DR

Roll: d6 — on an even number (2, 4, 6), the sabotage succeeds.

On success: The target loses half of all their PN output the next time they collect. The saboteur gains half of the lost output. This is applied per-PN, rounded down.

On failure: Cost is still paid. No effect.

2.1.3.3 Trading and Public Offers

Trading

Players may trade resources with each other during this phase. The process is as follows:

1. Write the trade on paper. It must clearly specify what is being offered and what is expected in return.
2. Read the trade aloud.
3. Both players must sign if they agree to the trade.
4. Counteroffers follow the same process.

Public Offers

Players may also make public offers:

1. Write your offer discreetly.
2. Fold the paper and place it in the center of the table.
3. Any player may view it privately.
4. The first player to sign the offer accepts it.
5. Each player only gets one look at the offer.

2.1.3.4 Alliances and Bribery

This is the phase in which players are encouraged to participate in any alliance building or bribery, but neither is required.

Alliances

To form an alliance, a player must write an Alliance Proposal Form (APF) that includes:

- Duration and/or goal of the alliance
- Shared resources or benefits
- Break conditions and penalties for breaking the alliance

The APF is sent discreetly to the intended ally. Counteroffers are allowed and follow the same process.

Bribery

Players may bribe other players:

1. Write the bribe on paper (any format).
2. Hand it discreetly to the target player.
3. The recipient signs 'A' (accept) or 'R' (reject).
4. No counteroffers are allowed for bribes.

2.1.4 Weaving Phase

2.1.4.1 Actions

The player may choose **up to three actions** from the following. Players may also **attempt a Weave** in the same phase (see Weaving Rules).

Resource Manipulation

- Spend 3 ToC (or 2 SN) to lower QR by 1.
- Spend 2 ToC (or 1 SN) to lower DR by 1.

Conversions (ToC as Flexible Currency)

ToC can be spent in place of other resources at the following exchange rates. These conversions are performed as Weaving Phase actions (see §2.1.4.1).

Conversion	Cost
1 DR	2 ToC
1 SN	3 ToC
1 TB	5 ToC
1 QR	1 ToC

Important: When converting, the ToC spent counts as usage of ToC for coefficient calculations. The gained resource counts as a gain of that resource (not as usage).

Player Interaction (DR-based Aggression)

- Spend 5 DR to force another player to lose 1 SN.
- Spend 15 ToC to insure your PNs from sabotage for 2 rounds.
- Spend 10 DR to force an opponent to lose 1 PN of their choice.
- Spend 7 DR to force another player to discard 2 resources of their choice.

Special Actions

- Spend 15 QR to trigger an Ethereal Chaos Event (ECE). Forcing an ECE also requires the player to skip their next turn.
- Spend 10 DR to force the Reality Constant (RC) to increase by 3.

Weaving-Related Actions

- Spend 15 ToC to reduce the RC by 5.
- Spend 10 DR to halve another player's Weaving Score (WS) by 50% for their next weave attempt. **This penalty persists across rounds until consumed.**

2.1.4.2 Weave Attempt

See *Weaving Rules* for full details on attempting to weave a Tapestry of Reality.

2.1.5 Reconciliation Phase

During this phase, players must resolve any penalties:

- For every 5 DR a player has, they must gain 1 QR.
- If a player has **20 or more QR**, they have created an unstable timeline and must forfeit their next turn, losing 5 QR and 5 ToC.
- If a player has **10 or more DR**, they must roll a d6. On a 5, an Ethereal Chaos Event is triggered.
- If a player has **15 or more DR**, they must roll a d6. On a 1 or 5, an Ethereal Chaos Event is triggered.

2.1.6 Ending Phase

During this phase, the player must do the following:

1. Ensure all resources are accurate, including any penalties that must be resolved.
2. Update the inflation tracker based on resource production for this round.
3. Update any manual notes, alliances, and table trackers that changed this round.

Game End Conditions

The game is won by either being the first to **weave 3 Tapestries of Reality (ToR)**, or winning via a **Dimensional Monopoly** (controlling >50% of all PN production for 5 consecutive rounds).

The game ends immediately if the Reality Constant ever reaches 100 or higher. At this point, all players lose as reality has collapsed from the overwhelming amount of chaos.

Coefficient Formula

To determine the weight of resources and the coefficients thereof, players must first determine how much one resource dominated a round. To find this out, players must use the following formula, having totaled the Resource Usage and Possible Usage of all players to determine the TRU and the TPU.

Base Coefficients

Coefficient	Symbol	Resource	Base Value	Role
Alpha	α	TB	1.4	Temporal Bridge weight (boost)
Beta	β	SN	1.1	Spatial Node weight (boost)
Gamma	γ	ToC	1.0	Thread of Continuity weight (boost)
Delta	δ	DR	1.1	Dimensional Ripple weight (drag)
Epsilon	ε	QR	1.15	Quantum Residue weight (drag)

Scaling Formula

Scaling Factor = ((Total Resource Usage / Total Possible Usage) - 0.6)^2

New Coefficient = Previous Coefficient × (1 ± Scaling Factor)

Adjustment Direction:

- If Usage > 50%: Subtract Scaling Factor (overuse penalty — coefficient pulled toward base)
- If Usage < 50%: Add Scaling Factor (neglect bonus — coefficient pushed further from base)
- If Usage = 50%: No change to the Scaling Factor

Coefficient Persistence: Coefficients carry forward from round to round. They are adjusted based on the previous round's coefficient value, NOT reset to their base value each round. If a resource has no usage data for a round, its coefficient remains unchanged from the previous round.

Possible Usage Timing: The total possible usage is determined from all players' combined resource totals at the start of each round, before any spending occurs.

Total Usage Timing: The total usage is determined from all players’ combined resources spent during the round.

This formula weighs resources by how much they are used in the round. Resources that are used heavily will have a lesser impact on the likelihood of success creating a ToR, while resources that are barely used throughout the round will have a greater impact.

Reality Constant Formula

To determine the Reality Constant for the round, use the following formula:

RC = Previous RC + R^1.5

Where R is the current round number.

As the game progresses, the RC will become increasingly unstable as the universe becomes more chaotic. This will force players to both act tactfully and adapt to the changing landscape as the game goes on, as well as fighting against the collapsing reality.

Example Progression (Standard Mode, Base RC = 10)

Round	R^1.5 (approx)	RC
1	1.0	11.0
2	2.8	13.8
3	5.2	19.0
4	8.0	27.0
5	11.2	38.2
6	14.7	52.9
7	18.5	71.4
8	22.6	94.0

Game Modes

Mode	Base RC	Difficulty
Casual	5	Easier — more time to develop strategies
Standard	10	Balanced — the default experience
Hardcore	15	Aggressive — fast collapse, high pressure

Alternative RC Formulas

Formula	Effect
Base RC + $R^{1.5}$	Stable — moderate growth
Base RC + R^{2}	Unstable — more pressure, less time to develop
Base RC + $R^{2.5}$	Chaotic — exponential collapse, very short games

Production Nodes (PNs)

Production Nodes (PNs) are structures that generate resources over time. Players can create and upgrade these nodes to generate resources for weaving attempts or further upgrades. PNs provide a critical way to scale up resource generation, but they also introduce risks, particularly as inflation affects overproduction.

1. Creating a Production Node

To create a PN, a player must pay the required resources to establish the node and choose which resource the PN will generate. SN (Spatial Nodes) is the primary currency for all PN construction.

Once a PN is purchased, the player will not start collecting resources from it until their following turn.

Base Creation Costs

Node Type	Cost	Produces
ToC Node	2 SN + 3 ToC	ToC
DR Node	3 SN + 4 DR	DR
TB Node	3 SN + 2 TB	TB
SN Node	6 SN	SN
QR Node	2 SN + 4 QR	QR

2. Upgrading a Production Node

Players can upgrade Production Nodes to increase their resource output. Each upgrade level increases output by 1 per round.

Upgrade cost = Creation cost minus 1 of each resource. The upgrade cost is the same at every level, making upgrading consistently cheaper than buying a new node of the same type.

Upgrade Costs (per level)

Node Type	Upgrade Cost
ToC Node	1 SN + 2 ToC
DR Node	2 SN + 3 DR
TB Node	2 SN + 1 TB
SN Node	5 SN
QR Node	1 SN + 3 QR

Maximum upgrade level: 4 (base level 1 + 3 upgrades).

3. PN Resource Collection

PN resources are collected automatically at the start of the Resource Collection Phase. In manual play, players collect their PN resources before rolling the dice.

Weaving Rules

Weaving a Tapestry of Reality is the primary way to win the game. Players commit positive resources (ToC, SN, TB) to boost their Weaving Score, while negative resources (DR, QR) and a base difficulty drag them down.

Weaving Score Formula

$WS = (\alpha \times TB + \beta \times SN + \gamma \times ToC) / (\delta \times DR + \varepsilon \times QR + baseDrag)$

Where:

- α, β, γ are the boost coefficients (for TB, SN, ToC respectively)
- δ, ε are the drag coefficients (for DR, QR respectively)
- **baseDrag = 0.5 + (RC / 100)** — this ensures there is always some difficulty, even with 0 DR and 0 QR. At RC 10, baseDrag is 0.6. At RC 50, baseDrag is 1.0. At RC 90, baseDrag is 1.4.

Important: DR and QR are used in the formula automatically from your current totals. They are NOT consumed by the weave attempt. You cannot opt out of their drag effect. Players should reduce DR and QR before weaving to improve their odds.

Tapestry of Reality Success Threshold (ToRST)

$ToRST = r \times \ln(RC + 1)$

Where r is a scaling factor equal to 1.5

Probability Threshold (PT)

$PT = k \times (WS / ToRST) \times 100$

Where k is a scaling factor equal to 1.5

Capped at 100%. Roll a d100 — if the roll ≤ ST, the weave succeeds.

QR Graduated Weaving Penalty

QR Range	Penalty
7-9	-3% PT
10-12	-6% PT
13-15	-10% PT
16-18	-15% PT
19+	-20% PT

Weave Attempt Resolution

Success: +1 Tapestry of Reality (ToR). RC decreases by 2 next round. Committed ToC/TB/SN are consumed.

Failure: Committed ToC/TB/SN are lost. RC increases by 1.

Actions + Weave

Players may take up to 3 actions AND attempt a weave in the same Weaving Phase.

Inflation

Inflation is evaluated at the end of each round based on the **combined total of each resource across all players' inventories**.

Inflation Thresholds

Resource	Threshold
ToC	30
TB	20
QR	45
DR	25
SN	20

Inflation Tiers

Tier	Condition	PN Efficiency	RC Penalty
Stable	≤ threshold	100%	None
Moderate	≤ 1.5× threshold	90%	+0.5 RC per 10 over
High	≤ 2× threshold	75%	+1 RC per 10 over
Severe	> 2× threshold	50%	+1.5 RC per 10 over

Ethereal Chaos Events (ECE)

Ethereal Chaos Events are powerful, disruptive events that affect all players. They can be triggered voluntarily (spending 15 QR during the Weaving Phase) or involuntarily (high DR during Reconciliation).

All ECE options require the initiator to forfeit their next turn.

ECE Options

Nebula Flush: The initiator loses all TB, SN, and ToC. All other players gain 5 QR and lose 2 DR. RC increases by 2.

Nebula Reset: ALL players (including the initiator) reset all resources to 0 and lose all Production Nodes. RC increases by 10. This is the nuclear option — mutually assured destruction.

Nebula Collapse: All players gain 15 QR, gain 10 DR, lose 50% of their TB (rounded down), and lose all SN above 5. RC increases by 5.

Nebula Fracture: Players split into two groups (Fissure A and Fissure B) for 2 rounds. The initiator chooses the groups. Groups can only interact within themselves during the fracture period. The smaller group gains 5 QR each. RC increases by 1 per round for 2 rounds.

Nebula Conflagration: All Production Nodes are inactive for 1 round. Players with 4 or more PNs must discard one PN of their choice. RC increases by 4.

Dimensional Monopoly

Win Condition: A player wins via Dimensional Monopoly if they control more than 50% of all PN production (outright majority, no ties) for **5 consecutive rounds**.

The monopoly streak is tracked automatically at the start of each round. If the controlling player's share drops below 50% or another player ties their share, the streak resets to 0.

Game Rule Change Proposal (GRCP)

The GRCP system is one of the most powerful and unique mechanics in Threads of Continuity. It allows players to propose changes to any rule in the game during their Merging Phase. This includes costs, thresholds, formulas, victory conditions, and even the GRCP process itself.

GRCP Process:

1. Documentation of the GRCP

The player bringing forth the GRCP must present the proposal in writing, detailing the current rule, what they want changed about that rule, and the reason for the change. After which, all players must agree unanimously on what is being proposed. Once agreed upon, all players must initial at the top of the document on the right side of the proposal.

2. Initial Vote for the GRCP

At this stage, there will be an initial, verbal vote for the GRCP. If there is a super majority in favor, the GRCP passes and the process skips to the Signing of the Final Decision of the GRCP phase.

If the initial vote fails, move onto the next phase below.

3. Initial Argument

The player bringing forth the GRCP must, at this stage, present a verbal argument lasting at least 90 seconds (announcing "minimum!" at this point), but not exceeding 120 seconds (announcing "time's up!" at this point). The time is to be kept by the person who has the lowest number of QRs.

4. Mutual Deliberations Regarding the GRCP

At this stage, all players will discuss the GRCP in question. The proposal may be adjusted by the players upon a unanimous agreement, wherein the player who initiated the GRCP will write in the changes to the GRCP on their initial document from phase 1. All players must initial next to the change.

If there are no adjustments, move onto the next phase.

5. Signing of the Final Decision Regarding the GRCP

This stage of the GRCP process is for all players who are voting in favor of the GRCP to sign at the bottom of the GRCP document, on the right side under the written proposal. All those opposed must sign on the left side. A super majority is required to pass the GRCP.

6. Documentation of the Final Decision of the GRCP

The final stage of the GRCP process includes the initiator of the GRCP to write in the official language of the new rule onto the Rule Adjustments Sheet. The final and signed GRCP will be archived under the Rule Adjustment Sheet for future reference.

Note: A unanimous vote is rewarded with a decrease of 2 RC.

Any rule in the game can be changed under a GRCP. This is intentional and by design. The GRCP system exists to allow the game to evolve during play, creating a meta-layer of governance and diplomacy that interacts with the resource and weaving mechanics.

Challenges

Challenges can be done to any item (any rule, action, decision, progression, or choice that has already occurred--anything that happens in the game due to player action) immediately after the action being challenged. If a second action has occurred since the action a player wants to challenge has occurred, that action can no longer be challenged. Challenges go through four phases:

1. Official Documentation of Challenge Phase
2. Initial Argument Phase
3. Mutual Deliberation Phase
4. Official Documentation of Final Decision Phase

1. Official Documentation of Challenge Phase

When a player challenges anything in the game, it must first be written down in summary in the notebook. All players must read the document and come to a unanimous decision as to what is being challenged.

2. Initial Argument Phase

Then, the player must give a speech to the rest of the players explaining why they are challenging the item lasting no less than 120 seconds (announcing "minimum!" at this point), and not more than 170 seconds (announcing "time's up!" at this point). The player being challenged must time them; if the player is challenging a game rule, then the player with the most ToC must time them. Please note that a challenge is *not* a Game Rule Change Proposal.

Once the challenger presents their argument, the player being challenged may offer a counterargument lasting no less than 75 seconds (announcing "minimum!" at this point), and not more than 150 seconds (announcing "time's up!" at this point). This player must be timed by the person challenging them.

3. Mutual Deliberation Phase

Once both parties have given their verbal arguments, the challenge moves to the deliberation phase in which all of the players engage in conversation regarding the challenge. This phase has no time limit and is only officially done when all players have unanimously decided that the deliberation phase is completed.

4. Official Documentation of Final Decision Phase

A super majority decision in favor of the challenge is required for the challenge to pass. Those in favor must sign the challenge document on the left side of the document under the written challenge, at the bottom of the document. Those opposed must sign the document on the left side. This document, once signed by all, will be set aside for reference later. Otherwise, if the challenge does not pass, the original item goes into play normally.

If a challenge is successful, the player that was challenged must undo all actions from that round that lead to the item being challenged and proceed with their turn.

Game Modifiers

2-Player Modifications

- Reduce starting ToC to 3.
- Reduce PN creation costs by 1 SN each.
- Monopoly victory requires only 3 consecutive rounds.